

Self-behaviour-development — compiled path

Compiled from `/Users/darkonikolic/Documents/learning/paths/Self-behaviour-development`. Canonical sources stay in place.

Phase — 01-operational-stance

Directory: `01-operational-stance/`

Source: `01-operational-stance/01-program-orientation-and-area-map.md`

Program orientation — how these folders relate

What this settles

High-stakes contexts reward **steady behaviour**, not panic-forged eloquence. Sheets stay short **on purpose**; depth arrives from living the moves, not stacking pages. Open folders **by friction** (`01 – 14`): whichever competency leaks tomorrow is tomorrow’s chapter—there is no secret mandatory sequence.

Nothing here replaces therapy or counsel. Where custody-shaped language appears, treat it as **communication literacy only**—align contested statements with whoever holds your legal brief.

Telemetry — which folder opens next

Treat the checklist as telemetry. Spot what slips often—pause collapsing, leaky channels, bites on provocations—and open matching folder rather than restarting the intro every time.

Rough scan across voice threads, chats, rooms:

Signal	☐
Breath lands before consonants exit	
Short chunk spoken → deliberate stop → silence waits on them	
One tactic active per sting (no stacking mid-adrenaline)	
Regulated torso before argumentative mind	
Outward-facing calm; confession stays compartmentalised	

Give calendar weight to whichever row feels chronically weakest.

Three-line checkpoint (no spiral)

1. Highest-stakes audience or conduit recently: _____
2. Fastest disappearing row above: _____
3. Folder you open next (`01 – 14`): _____

Folder map (`paths/Self-behaviour-development/`)

#	Folder	Role
01	<code>01-operational-stance/</code>	Compass, FAST, mantra, Important/Risky/Goal triage
02	<code>02-regulation-and-recovery/</code>	Somatic resets, truthful delay lines, sleep/load, movement, nutrition, energy budgeting
03	<code>03-observer-loop/</code>	Observer separation + post-talk factual landing
04	<code>04-cognitive-distortion-literacy/</code>	Interpretive traps & biases → facts vs guesses before you argue
05	<code>05-communication-under-pressure/</code>	Pace, scaffolding answers, numbered techniques, presence
06	<code>06-situation-literacy/</code>	Classifying payloads, unpacking leading frames
07	<code>07-audiences-channels-boundaries/</code>	Audience discipline, starving noisy amplifiers
08	<code>08-behaviour-as-signal/</code>	Register hygiene, observable stability cues
09	<code>09-daily-mechanics/</code>	Universal micro preamble before heavier contact
10	<code>10-drills-and-exercise-archive/</code>	Scenario loops + integration scaffolding
11	<code>11-reflection-evening-loop/</code>	Three nightly questions + debottleneck motions
12	<code>12-active-life-design/</code>	Life-building beyond siege posture, conflict ladders, positive bandwidth
13	<code>13-professional-work-load/</code>	Workplace fault lines under stacked stress
14	<code>14-appendix-custody-expert-proceedings/</code>	Evaluator-style prep & dense rehearsal banks

Line holding the spine

Living the gestures changes outcomes; skim-reading substitutes nothing.

Siblings inside this folder

- [Important / risky / goal triage](#)
- [FAST kernel chain](#)
- [Three-layer mantra scaffold](#)

Source: `01-operational-stance/02-energy-routing-triad-important-risky-goal.md`

Energy routing — important · risky · does a real goal exist

What this settles

Train a sub-five-second calculus: **Does this messenger matter to my actual responsibilities? carries asymmetric risk? attaches to a workable aim?** — then choke bandwidth consciously instead of debating yourself into burnout.

Story / lens

Few pings merit equal arousal budgets. Neither importance-only nor justice feelings justify feeding bottomless arenas. Important-without-payoff-but-high-risk ⇒ shift to transactional tone, textual trace, or delegated escalation — not live duels meant for counsel / HR equivalents. Labels **Important · Risk · Goal** dovetail broader sequencing in [Conflict ladders](#) and FAST routing [here](#).

Moves

1. **Mental sting sets** (~10 cues) — imagine precise hooks (traffic blame ping, petty workplace dig, parental guilt lure). Vocalise exclusively `Imp=yes/no · Risk=yes/no · Goal=yes/no/absent`. If importance & aim both evaporate ⇒ **minimal or silent plan**. Pace target <5 seconds; zero fantasy closing argument.

2. **One starvation corridor weekly** — name an attention sink (human, feed, chatter group) yielding negative ROI; document the guardrail once; annotate one lapse without moral tribunal.

Neighbours

[Program compass](#)

Source: 01-operational-stance/03-fast-playbook.md

FAST core — seven kernels + micro-pipeline

What this settles

Moment-of-contact automation: **one breath**, internal triage, choose macro move, **one operative sentence**, then stay quiet while the outer world reacts.

FAST shorthand: Breath → Worth/Risk/Situation type (**A|M|I|N**) → choose **Enter / Minimal / Distance / Exit** → **one** sentence delivered → wait-without-padding.

Types: **A** aggression · **M** manipulation/play · **I** institution / record-bearing · **N** workable normal dialogue.

Story / lens

Second sentences smuggle regret; adrenaline loves stacking tactics simultaneously. Institutional **I** channel wants dry, factual, survivable neutrality; aggression wants low tone plus prepared exit—not ego arm wrestle. Maintain a revolving five-line repertoire recognisably *yours*, not borrowed screenplay dialect.

Seven kernel jobs (adapt language — preserve behavioural job):

1. Reciprocity reality — stop sprinting after indifference · 2. Micro boundary / fidelity probe · 3. Pause outperforms twitch · 4. One sentence ⇔ one point · 5. Honour absent respect with retreat · 6. Institutional = brief third-person façade · 7. Departures owe no trophy speech

Moves

- **Morning kernel chorus** till order memorises cleanly without prompts.
- **Letter + operative line reps** (~15 cues): classify **A|M|I|N**, follow with **exactly one** predetermined line from your revolving cache — discard round if unauthorised clause arrives before counterpart's pause settles.
- **0–4 intensity calibration** voiced as digits only paired with shorthand behaviour label (no improvised monologue):
0 ignore / withhold fuel · **1** lone neutral operative line · **2** explicit boundary wording · **3** thematic terminal stop · **4** disconnect channel / leave / escalate legally or professionally

Neighbours

[Triage worksheet](#)

Source: 01-operational-stance/04-three-layer-operational-mantra.md

Mantra scaffolding — thin daily / widening weekly / deep seldom

What this settles

Short memorised clauses **bend posture** faster than argumentative intellect under flood states. Layers differ by **bandwidth appetite, not superiority** — misusing deepest lines to marinate ordinary annoyance substitutes mood spiral for locomotion.

Story / lens

Core survives arousal rehearsals; **Daily / Weekly** rotates wider fidelity toward dependents + institutions episodically; **Deep** answers genuine existential fog — not habitual irritability arcs.

Compose personal analogue lines offline aligning with your ethos without mimic-the narrator theatre. Vocal delivery anchors soft jaw + diaphragm pacing (companied by [02-regulation-and-recovery sheets](#)).

Moves

1. **Dawn strand (~7 mornings pilot)** neutral spine inhale softly / elongated exhale / speak Core bits between tails / sealing exhale — skip immediate journaling afterward.
2. **Weekly widen + outward stitch** pull four widening sentences; pronounce slowly deliberately; nominate **precisely one public-facing behaviour hinge** activating before toughest human loadings that day (“no speculative drafting before advisor channel”, “movement lap before contentious coparent pings”, ...). Evening binary pass ledger—skip essay debrief attached.
3. **Deep spare trigger** pervasive numb plateau or forgotten vector days: whisper entire deep constellation once aloud · inside **ten manifested minutes** commit **tiny exterior motion only** nourishment / gait / scaffolding safe drafts.

Boundary outward stance

Rough can remain scope-honouring; intending harm disqualifies playbook use.

Neighbours

[Energy triage](#) · [FAST chain](#)

Phase — 02-regulation-and-recovery

Directory: [02-regulation-and-recovery/](#)

Source: [02-regulation-and-recovery/01-grounding-micro-label-emotion.md](#)

Grounding capsule + single-word inner label

What this settles

Install a **tiny somatic prelude** ahead of lexical choice whenever intensity climbs: soles bearing weight, soft jaw audit, elongated exhale, *then* you speak—or you consciously defer speaking.

Story / lens

Arousal data lands before argumentative mind finishes drafting; diaphragm lengthens, jaws disengage before consonants ⇒ hijack incidence drops. Inward mono-token affect labels truncate rumination scaffolding inside outbound messages—they are rehearsal for sovereignty, **not melodrama performed for hostile witnesses**. Stakes implying durable records ⇒ keep physiology + labelling quieter than courtroom theatre.

Moves

- **Ten real insertions inside one waking day:** before keystrokes/voice—even “small” pings—feel feet-floor contact → jaw slack check → exhale subtly longer than inhale → permit content afterward. Honour body even inside imagined-only rehearsal sometimes.
- **Five isolated spike glimpses:** when irritation spikes solo whisper **one inward token** ([anger](#) , [pressure](#) , ...) forbidding indictment storyline → bifurcate consciously **respond now versus delay/channel reroute**.

Neighbours

[Window resets & truthful delay wording](#) · [FAST backbone](#) · [Sleep & fatigue guardrails](#)

Source: [02-regulation-and-recovery/02-window-reset-time-anchor.md](#)

Tolerance window, reset ladders, truthful delay wording, anchors

What this settles

Recognise drifting **outside functional nervous-system bandwidth** sooner; intervene with physiology + containment labelling inside ~30 seconds; deploy **truthful postpone lines** ethically; anchors only after deliberate pairing groundwork.

Story / lens

“Off-window” isn’t melodrama wording—it resembles executive narrowing: looping absolutist thoughts, cervical lock voice, argumentative magnetism irresistible. Buying time honours integrity when timelines promised are **real** (“I’ll revert after verifying documents”) — invented deadlines poison institutional trust. Anchors become optional amplifiers **only after** serene pairing nights; gimmick substitutes absent repetition mislead nobody including yourself.

Moves

- **Recognition deck** — jot six unmistakable tells; shuffle verbally naming tell + obligatory first manoeuvre (**exhale + feet-floor feel alone**, never instant debate).

- **Reset ladder repetitions (~5 arcs)** resurrect last conflict memory or surrogate role play: inward tag (**role + procedural container—not entire biography**) ⇒ shoulder-drop exhale ⇒ **singular** micro-move (muted sentence vs dignified silence vs honest defer phrase).

Timer ≤30 seconds total.

- **Truthful postpone inventory** forge **two phrases** calibrated per arena (employment / co-parenting / clinician) spoken aloud calmly ×10 rotations each—discard anything promising schedules you intend to fracture.

- **Anchor clause** practise calm pairing bedtime micro ≥5 successive nights premised before courtroom deployment else omit strata entirely.

Neighbours

[Grounding primer](#) · [Observer scaffolding](#) · [Sleep & fatigue guardrails](#)

Source: 02-regulation-and-recovery/03-sleep-protection-fatigue-and-recovery-signals.md

Sleep protection — fatigue awareness and recovery signals

What this settles

Treat **sleep and fatigue** as behaviour inputs, not morality metrics. Chronic depletion bends tone, narrows empathy, exaggerates catastrophe reading, and makes **distortion slips** statistically likely—before “character” enters the chat.

Recovery starts with **protection**: fewer predictable self-sabotage nights, clearer early-warning signals.

Story / lens

Institutional and relational arenas punish **wired-reactive versions** of you even when your reasons for sleeplessness are sympathetic. Labels like “fine” deny information; behavioural guardrails honour information without melodrama.

Moves

Inventory **seven fatigue tells** uniquely yours (verbal snapping, skim-reading, doom loops, sugary autopilot)—post visibly until automatic.

Establish **three non-negotiable sleep hygiene knobs** realistic for your custody/work reality (timing anchor, phone boundary, caffeine cutoff—pick what you will keep).

Weekly one line calendar note: average sleep trajectory (↑ / → / ↓)—no sermon, trend only.

Pair repeated “I blew it again” bedtime shame with factual log: hours slept × stress spikes × next-day conflict risk—witness table not verdict.

Heavy week incoming → pre-place **recovery pad** on calendar smaller than fantasies bigger than zero.

Neighbours

[Grounding capsule](#) · [Movement & nutrition under strain](#)

Source: 02-regulation-and-recovery/04-movement-nutrition-under-stress.md

Movement and nutrition — simple levers under stress

What this settles

Behaviour under siege is partly **engineering**: movement and nourishment move nervous-system bandwidth more reliably than eloquence when reservoirs are drained. This sheet avoids ideology—only **minimal durable levers**.

Story / lens

Nobody needs new identity as “biohacker”; you need repeatable defaults so **communication** decisions are not made on blood-sugar fumes alone. Honour medical constraints individually; clinicians win arguments this sheet cannot adjudicate.

Moves

Define **movement floor** honestly (walk block count, stretching micro, stairs policy) + weekly completion hash marks—truth beats ambition.

Hydration + predictable meal timing checkpoints when history shows hanger-driven escalation.

Prep **three grab meals** lawful for your constraints frozen or staple—decision avoidance when depleted.

Treat alcohol / sedative bargains under stress honestly: behavioural cost note line only—non-preach.

Neighbours

[Sleep guardrails](#) · [Energy budget & overload](#)

Source: 02-regulation-and-recovery/05-energy-budget-overload-scheduling-recovery.md

Energy budget — overload, decision fatigue, recovery scheduling

What this settles

Decision fatigue and **cognitive overload** degrade the same faculties you rely on for boundaries, pacing, and clean wording—usually before you consciously notice vocabulary shrinking.

Recovery scheduling and **energy budgeting** mean choosing where finite attention goes *before* emergencies pick for you.

Story / lens

Siege seasons tempt **heroic cramming**: every fight open, zero slack. Behavioural realism names **fewer decisive battles**, protected sleep/movement anchors, buffered decision slots. This neighbours **FAST triage** and **importance/risk/goal routing** intentionally.

Overload also feeds **interpretive traps**—repair load first when spirals correlate with depleted weeks.

Moves

Maintain **attention ledger** weekdays: columns *must decide today* · *can wait* · *belongs to advisor/procedure*.

Cap **heavy decisions/day** pragmatically—queue overflow explicitly.

Weekly **recovery block** defended like medical appointment—even quiet logistics counts.

Identify **automatic decisions** templates (meal rotation, bedtime protocol, clothed weekday exit) shedding micro-choices drained arenas steal.

Overload episode post-mortem: three bullets *sleep* · *fuel* · *movement* · *unclosed loops* factual only.

Neighbours

[Movement & nutrition](#) · [Window resets](#)

Phase — 03-observer-loop

Directory: 03-observer-loop/

Source: 03-observer-loop/01-meta-observer-three-levels.md

Observer fabric — Body · Impulse · Narrative braid

What this settles

You learn to perceive **distinct channels simultaneously** rather than collapsing into whatever story catastrophe offers first: body signals, impulses to flee/snipe/ghost, explanatory narratives—all observed without instantaneous fusion (“**I equals the indictment**” disappears as default).

Story / lens

Courtroom-ish rooms downgrade rhetorical virtuosity celebrating **steady affect** + truthful minimal wording. Observation ≠ moral sentencing yourself — it inventories channels so physiology + procedural reset prime, then **interpretive hygiene separates inference from datum**, before you choose communication manoeuvres (**order**: regulate → distortion check → corridor clarity → linguistic tactic). Companion reflections live **after-contact notes** + **FAST**.

Moves

- ~15 **skim labels** aloud: prompt list (solo/partner flash) ⇒ answer first dominant channel **Body / Impulse / Story**—no argumentative defence of diagnosis.
- **Two-minute vigil** seated silently: each diversion craving (thumb scroll / snack phantom / triumphant courtroom fantasy) ⇒ whisper inward **Impulse** then breath anchor—not hunting zero urges, hunting visible catches frequency.
- **Partner sting ladders** escalate neutral ⇒ sharp interrogatives one-at-a-time: answer **minimal safe clause** practising notice→ exhale→word chain; afterward log exactly **three tokens** {observer-stable / impulse / slipped-on-_____}.

Ordering with regulation + tactics

Observe → physiology / honest postpone if needed → **interpretation sanity pass** → select **communication manoeuvre** — never reversing that stack during heat.

Source: 03-observer-loop/02-after-talk-reset-and-review.md

After turbulence — factual landing versus shame screenplay

What this settles

Replace automatic **trial-by-imagination verdict** (“I demolished everything catastrophically”) with slim **truth tables** anchored outside catastrophic identity fusion. When the story is **probability theatre**, tag **distortion literacy** before rewriting history.

Story / lens

Amygdala offers prosecutorial screenplay immediately post friction. Three-row capture reframes residues as **witness-neutral facts, descriptor-only response geometry, next lever behavioural tweak** rather than melodrama loops reopening dossiers at bedtime. Pair evening psychological compression with **Three evening questions** so rumination bedtime pipeline breaks.

Moves

Maintain tri-table after heavy human contact ASAP:

Line	Prompt
External moment snapshot	single neutral witnessing sentence
Response geometry	descriptive adjectives only (short , loud ,...)
Adjustment lever forthcoming	solitary behavioural hinge next iteration

Forbidden row: scripted “**everything ruined**” monologue.

Micro-reset cluster audible micro-exhale + shoulder slump permission + cognition tag **fresh cue fresh aperture** rehearsal post role-play equivalents.

Evening coherence check: shame soliloquy paused—table dictated or handwritten concise.

Neighbours

[Observer braid](#) · [Evening trio](#)

Source: 03-observer-loop/02-observer-daily-log.md

Observer daily log — channel inventory, not self-prosecution

After any contact that activated your system — difficult conversation, written exchange, or internal pressure spike — fill this within 30 minutes. Sooner than that: too hot. Later than 30 min: details blur.

The three channels

You observe these simultaneously. The goal is to name them — not fuse into the story.

Channel	What it tracks	Example signal
Body	Physical sensations, tension, breath changes	Chest tightening, jaw clenching, faster breathing, stillness
Impulse	Urge to act before thinking	Want to reply now, want to leave, want to prove, want to snipe
Story	The narrative your mind generates	“They’re trying to corner me”, “I’m failing”, “This means…”

Post-contact entry (fill within 30 min)

Date / time: _____
Contact type: ☐ In-person ☐ Written ☐ Phone ☐ Internal pressure (no contact)
Context (1 line): _____

BODY – what did I notice?

IMPULSE – what did I want to do in the moment?

STORY – what narrative ran first?

Did I act from body/impulse, or did I observe first?
☐ Observed first – paused, then responded
☐ Acted from impulse – response came before observation
☐ Mixed – partly observed, partly reactive

What did I actually do?

One token label:
☐ Observer-stable – noticed without fusing
☐ Impulse – acted from urgency
☐ Slipped on: _____ (name the specific distortion or pattern)

Worked example

Date / time: 2026-03-14 18:45
Contact type: [x] Written – email from opposing party
Context: Message questioned my parenting decision. Implied negligence.

BODY: Chest tightened. Warm face. Sat forward toward screen.
IMPULSE: Wanted to reply immediately with three paragraphs defending myself.
STORY: "They're building a case against me. This will be used in court."

Did I act from body/impulse?
[x] Mixed – paused for 2 minutes, then drafted reply. Sent after 20 min review.

What I did:
Waited 20 minutes, reread message, classified it as [P = Provocation] per situation literacy. Replied with two factual sentences only.

Token: Observer-stable – classified first, replied second.

Weekly pattern scan

Once a week, look at your log entries. Count:

Observer-stable entries: ____
Impulse entries: ____
Slipped on [____]: ____ (note which pattern appears most)

If one pattern appears 3+ times in a week — it goes into the drill schedule for that scenario type.

Integration

Impulse entries feed into [Six routing cards drill](#) — practice the specific scenario type that triggered the impulse.

Slipped-on patterns feed into [Cognitive distortion literacy](#) — verify which distortion was running.

Stable entries matter too — note which skill moved (pause, technique routing, breath anchor) so you can deliberately repeat it.

Phase — 04-cognitive-distortion-literacy

Directory: [04-cognitive-distortion-literacy/](#)

Source: [04-cognitive-distortion-literacy/01-interpretive-traps-reading-minds-catastrophizing-absolutes.md](#)

Interpretive traps — reading minds, catastrophizing, absolutes

What this settles

Name the **guess-as-fact** habits that inflate conflict volume before anybody opens their mouth properly: assuming hostile intent (**mind-reading**), running worst-case theatres (**catastrophizing**), compressing gradients into verdicts (**all-or-nothing**), trusting feeling as proof (**emotional reasoning**), assigning others your motives (**projection**) without evidence.

Conflict heat rarely starts from naked facts alone—it starts from **interpretation licences** welded to adrenaline.

Story / lens

These patterns are boringly common—not character flaws—in high-stakes load. Labels exist so you can downgrade story speed and route back to observable events before **communication manoeuvres** inherit a lie your nervous system prefers.

Interpretive hygiene nests after **regulation** and **observer labelling**: body calmer → channels named → distortion named → wording chosen.

Moves

Maintain a **five-column flash card** mentally (or ink): *Trigger phrase they used · story you told · distortion tag · factual minimum you actually know · one neutral next question*.

Collect **six recent spirals**, label each distortion type once without prosecuting yourself—only pattern ID.

Practice spoken **downgrade sentences**: “What I assumed was , **what was actually observable was** ”—no victory tone; logistics only.

Rehearse declining **courtroom rehearsals in your skull** after ambiguous texts: default is delay + verification, not instant sentencing.

Pair chronic “they always...” loops with **leading frames worksheet** when the other person’s language smuggles premises.

Neighbours

[Attribution & confirmation under strain](#) · [Uncertainty tolerance](#)

Source: [04-cognitive-distortion-literacy/02-attribution-confirmation-availability-biases.md](#)

Attribution, confirmation, availability — justice feelings vs evidence

What this settles

Spot how stress tilts **how you assign blame** (**fundamental attribution error**—their character vs your circumstances), **how you hunt facts** (**confirmation bias**—noticing what fits the verdict), and **how vivid examples hijack probability** (**availability bias**—last ugly message feels like universal law).

Layer **projection awareness** here when you attribute motives you fear in yourself. Keep each tag short; the move is earlier correction, not academic taxonomy.

Story / lens

Under load, memory serves **coherence** (the story already installed) more than **completeness**. That makes peaceful channels look fake and hostile ones look “obvious.” Slowing one notch protects **channel discipline** and keeps paperwork aligned with what you can actually show.

Moves

For three fresh frictions, write two lines: **Internal headline (justice version)** vs **Witness-only caption (camera version)**. If the gap is huge, park the headline before sending.

Disconfirm search: one sentence of evidence *against* your favourite theory—must be honest; if none exists yet, label *unknown*.

Motivation hypotheses: downgrade “they did it because evil” → “possible drivers include , —I haven’t verified which.” Stop at plausible plural unless procedure demands proof.

Stress-volume check: revisit after **sleep/load sheet** whenever bias labels spike at night—the same quarrel reads different when depleted.

Neighbours

[Interpretive traps](#) · [Uncertainty tolerance](#)

Source: 04-cognitive-distortion-literacy/03-uncertainty-tolerance-and-stress-amplification.md

Uncertainty tolerance — stress amplification and living in the grey

What this settles

Uncertainty tolerance is the practice of refusing to buy temporary relief by forcing premature closure—“*I must know now*” becomes a second fight layered on the first. **Stress amplification** is the feedback loop where arousal magnifies threat reading, which spikes arousal again.

These sit next to interpretation work: not everything ambiguous is an emergency; not every emergency benefits from instant narrative.

Story / lens

Conflict channels reward **decisive tone**; private life rewards **accurate timing**. Many escalations are attempts to metabolise anxiety as if it were information. Legitimate unknowns deserve **honest postpone lines**, delegated fact-finding, or counsel-shaped channels—not improvised conviction.

Overload and fatigue multiply **stress amplification**; pair this sheet deliberately with **energy budgeting**.

Moves

Identify **five uncertainty triggers** (silence stretches, procedural delays, co-parent logistical fog). For each, script **one comportment line that tolerates grey** (“I’ll answer once X is verified”) aligned with truthful calendars.

Practice **ninety-second urge surf** twice weekly when compulsion spikes to conclude/fight: timer only; no outbound message—note whether catastrophe intensity actually moves.

Night rule: forbid **resolution-by-text** threads after a chosen cutoff when history shows degraded reading.

Tag **stress amplification spikes** bodily (heat, narrowing vision) then run **grounding capsule** before re-opening the ambiguity.

Schedule **recovery blocks** consciously—this is not softness; anchor them with **energy budgeting**—so uncertainty does not permanently mean deprivation.

Neighbours

[Interpretive traps](#) · [Bias & attribution](#)

Phase — 05-communication-under-pressure

Directory: [05-communication-under-pressure/](#)

Source: [05-communication-under-pressure/01-golden-chain-pause-structure-silence.md](#)

Golden chain — pause · chunk · chosen silence

What this settles

Shape default cadence [stimulus → intentional gap \(~2 seconds early phase\) → 1-3 sentence cluster → purposeful stop → no filler syllables awaiting their cue](#). Silence becomes **architecture**, not indictment.

Story / lens

Panels reward **regulated tempo**. Micro-gap purchases honest processing clocks; interviewer steering modular Q&A receives iterative chunks instead of improvised manifesto dumps. Anxiety relabel: quiet slot ≠ character failing.

Moves

- **Mechanical pacing reps** audible neutral prompts ⇒ visible two-second widening early phase ⇒ answer capped three sentences ⇒ mouth sealed until tactile next cue ⇒ eradicate “...and another thing” parasite across ten arcs.
- **Dual block breathing** heavier prompts ⇒ max **two** blocks first week segments each ≤three sentences partitioned by conspicuous breath-shoulder slump ⇒ internal cap ~45s continuous speech ⇒ forced split.
- **Silence reassurance micro-line** inward whisper “**slot—not failure**” once when quiet itchy—no audible filler injection.

Calibration: ten arcs without compulsive apology-for-quiet sentence.

Neighbours

[Three-phase scaffolding](#) · [Observer fabric](#) · [Interpretive hygiene](#)

Source: [05-communication-under-pressure/02-three-phase-opening-substance-close.md](#)

Three-move answer shaping — optional frame · core · grounding close

What this settles

Allow answers to adopt **opening frame** → **factual centre** → **stabilising orientation** selectively—not every interrogative demands theatrical triple scaffolding; often **middle alone suffices**.

Story / lens

Outer frame orients politely; nucleus answers question actually asked; grounding line returns dependents / agendas / logistical north star without argumentative detouring. Oversized banks tempt cramming ornate frames blindly—sense **stripping needless jacket** consciously. Rhythm discipline borrows pacing rigour neighbouring [golden chain](#).

Sentence inventory inspiration (adapt voice): courteous opener (“To stay precise...”), middle factual vertebra, grounding orientation (“What I can commit next is...”).

Moves

~**Twenty mixed prompts aloud** annotate mentally **needs frame? grounding tail?** pre-speech → answer accordingly (often nucleus alone).
Heavy prompt single pass: enact complete triplet ≤4 succinct cumulative sentences aloud; recorder playback judges escalation slope not lexical jewellery.

Source: 05-communication-under-pressure/03-six-techniques-and-negation-protocol.md

Six routing cards + layered negation cadence

What this settles

Tag situations with **digits 1–6** shorthand so adrenaline stops inventing improvised mash-ups each reply cycle; layered accusations ascend **premise refusal** → **jurisdictional boundary** → **forward pivot vector** cleanly without mirrored insult initials.
Routing crib:

#	When helpful
1	Straight narrowly scoped factual
2	Redirect toward stewardship / care-forward without psychoanalysing absent third-parties aloud
3	Precision tighten vague bombardments
4	Honour truthful partial witness fences
5	Capability / channel redirection
6	Scaffold refusing harmful accusation architecture

Forbidden pattern: chaining multiple cards inside single rejoinder adrenaline storm.

Story / lens

Numerals exist **only as routing compression** preventing simultaneous moralise+litigate impulses. Institutional / record-bearing arenas prize sparse nouns—not insult theatre openings.

Moves

Deck ~**18 stimuli** ⇒ speak digit after first heartbeat ⇒ track <~2 seconds stability.
Rotate spoken answers ×12 insisting **solo technique** each—or log contamination when mixing inadvertently.
Synthetic accusation tapestry ×6 strands—each spoken triad (**reject premise · boundary wording · behavioural pivot**) under fifteen aggregated seconds ⇒ monotone armour; zero insult rhyme openings.

Source: 05-communication-under-pressure/04-nonverbal-voice-and-presence.md

Non-verbal fascia — tempo · shoulders · humane gaze · anti-spasm gestures

What this settles

Conscious stewardship of outward shell: moderated cadence; shoulder stack lowered; palms visible calmly; reciprocal humane gaze intervals (not glaring nor glued to floor); resisting urge to verbally patch silences prematurely; outlawing caricature spikes.

Story / lens

Lexical choreography loses contests observers score mainly by **animation profile**. Hostile arenas weaponise audible sneer-exhales to bait chain escalation. Prefer a lightweight **silent checklist** over obsessive self-camera rumination mid-sentence: steady medium vocal amplitude, humane gaze rhythmic micro-breaks, cancelling dismissive hiss-breaths that invite tit-for-tat heat.

Moves

Film ~30s neutral rehearsal answering a vanilla prompt; audit only:

1. Pace slower than caffeinated default
2. Shoulders not riding ear-line
3. Hands calm and visible
4. Eyes humane, not glare or floor-lock
5. No panic syllables during intentional silence wells
6. No sudden sweeping gesture spikes

Repeat until all pass—or pick one focus for the next pass.

Cull one chronic micro-twitch (eye-roll, jitter laugh, dismissive exhale). Substitute: blink + jaw soft + one measured breath; three short daily passes until absent on recording.

Neighbours

[Golden chain pacing](#)

Phase — 06-situation-literacy

Directory: `06-situation-literacy/`

Source: `06-situation-literacy/01-classifying-messages-information-provocation-hooks.md`

Message tagging — Inform · Provoke · Hook narrative

What this settles

Before reacting, imprint **tiny bucket labels** distinguishing real information pulls from provocation payloads or storyline bait — interrupting autopilot argumentative soup.

Story / lens

Misreading logistical curiosity as summons to autobiographical defence corrodes adjudicatory patience once stakes climb. Classification latency pushes **routing** toward **six routing cards** rather than improvised cross-examination once stamped **Provoke / Hook**.

Moves

Harvest ~**30 arduous lines** (saved threads, voicemail transcripts, or rehearsal banks in **appendix sheet**) — margin tag **only I | P | H** on a first pass without answering yet — sanity cross-check instincts against exemplars inside `05-communication-under-pressure` when ambiguity persists.

Iterate **toughest dozen**: whisper label then aloud speak matching **solo technique digit** referencing **routing cards** — defer full scripted reply until numbering reflex slips below ~2 median seconds across sessions.

When an ally piles on rapid overlapping questions in rehearsal, deploy pause gesture plus courteous **one-at-a-time** pacing before resuming bounded answers.

Neighbours

[Cognitive distortion literacy](#) · [Ambiguous & leading frames](#)

Source: `06-situation-literacy/02-ambiguous-leading-suggestive-hypotheticals.md`

Leading questions, ambiguities, hypotheticals — premise hygiene

What this settles

Expose **smuggled factual premises** inside ornate questions; decline adopting them wholesale; answer with **precision tightening** or **channel deferral** rather than ghost-scenario confessions.

Story / lens

Leading architecture tries installing conclusions you never agreed. Narrowing probes (**which instance?, which window?, which success metric?**) resurrect shared referential ground instead of debating imagination landscapes. When premises feel judicially tinted deferral / counsel channel may trump spontaneous speculation. Pair with **channel routing** whenever precision alone would leak strategically dangerous detail.

Moves

~**Twenty written questions** underline buried truth-claim — speak aloud `premise = ____` explicitly.

Per underlined chunk practise **one narrowing line** aloud using allowed variants (*which example / timeframe / criterion?*).

Five “**if X proven you must admit monstrosity...**” style frames — answer exclusively using **boundary skeleton + channel reroute** vocabulary — forbid building alternate universe plotlines emotionally.

Sanity: recordings contain **zero** accidental “yeah if that’s true I guess I’m irredeemable...” spirals.

Neighbours

Cognitive distortion literacy · Inform / provoke / hooks

Source: 06-situation-literacy/03-message-classification-drill.md

Message classification drill — I · P · H routing practice

Practice before the real messages arrive. 30 lines, solo, 15–20 minutes. Goal: classification reflex under 2 seconds.

Classification system

Tag	Stands for	What it is
I	Inform	Genuine request for factual information or logistics
P	Provoke	Designed to trigger emotional response — correct answer is no insult mirror
H	Hook	Invites you into a narrative or story frame you didn’t author and shouldn’t defend

Drill procedure

- Step 1.** Read each line below. Do not answer it. Assign only I / P / H.
- Step 2.** After tagging all 30, go back and for P and H items: pick one routing card (1–6) per item.
- Step 3.** For your toughest 5–8 items: speak the tag aloud + routing digit within 2 seconds of re-reading.

Routing card reference (from Six routing cards)

#	Use when...
1	Narrowly scoped factual — answer directly, briefly
2	Redirect to child/care-forward without psychoanalyzing absent parties
3	Precision — tighten a vague or bombardment question
4	Partial witness — you can confirm a fact, but not the full accusation
5	Channel redirect — this belongs to a different person or process
6	Refuse the premise — the question assumes something you do not accept

Drill set A — low to medium intensity

Classify each (I / P / H) and, for P and H, add routing digit.

- “What time does pick-up happen on Saturday?”
- “You always make everything about yourself.”
- “Everyone can see what kind of person you really are.”
- “Did you confirm the appointment with the doctor?”
- “Why do you think the children are happy with you?”
- “Can you send me the school schedule for next month?”
- “After everything I’ve done, this is how you behave.”

8. "What does your therapist say about your anger issues?"
 9. "I need the insurance documents by end of week."
 10. "You were always the difficult one in the relationship."
-

Drill set B — medium to high intensity

1. "Have you explained to the children why we are in this situation?"
 2. "Don't you think the children deserve a stable parent?"
 3. "I'm just asking a simple question — why can't you answer it?"
 4. "What time will you be back with the children on Sunday?"
 5. "Your behavior in the last meeting was embarrassing for everyone."
 6. "Is it true that you told the children X?" (where X is false)
 7. "How much do you earn per month currently?"
 8. "My parents are worried about the children's wellbeing."
 9. "Why do you think you're a better parent than I am?"
 10. "I need written confirmation of the arrangement we discussed."
-

Drill set C — sustained pressure and combined patterns

1. "You did X, then Y, then Z — don't you see the pattern?" (multiple accusations stacked)
 2. "The children told me what happened. I think we both know the truth."
 3. "Can we just talk like adults for once?"
 4. "What's your plan for the summer holidays?"
 5. "Everyone who knows you says the same thing."
 6. "I'm not angry. I just want to understand why you chose to do that."
 7. "Don't you feel guilty?"
 8. "What are your thoughts on joint custody going forward?"
 9. "You know this is going to come up in the proceedings."
 10. "I'm doing this for the children. I hope you can say the same."
-

Answer key (sample — your judgment may differ)

#	Tag	Routing (P/H only)
1	I	—
2	P	6 (refuse premise — “always” is not accurate)
3	P	6 (refuse premise — “everyone” is not a source)
4	I	—
5	H	2 (care-forward redirect)
6	I	—
7	P	6 (refuse premise)
8	H	4 (partial witness + 5 channel redirect)
9	I	—
10	P	6
11	H	2
12	H	2 + 6
13	P	3 (precision — what is the question exactly?)
14	I	—
15	P	6
16	P/H	4 (partial witness — you can address what you know is factual)
17	I or P	depends on context — answer factually if legally relevant
18	H	2
19	H	6 (refuse comparative framing)
20	I	—
21	P/H	3 (precision) + 6 (refuse compound accusation)
22	H	4 (partial witness — you cannot verify what was said to them)
23	P	3 (precision — “like adults” is not a standard)
24	I	—
25	P	6
26	P	6 (the framing is not neutral — observe the body channel first)
27	P/H	6
28	I/H	depends — answer factually if safe to do so
29	P	4 (you note the comment, you do not engage with the threat)
30	H	2

Weekly rotation rule

Do not drill the same set twice in a row. Rotate: A → B → C → A.

After each session: log one line — which item was hardest and why.

Pattern: if the same item type appears hard repeatedly → it identifies the scenario cluster to rehearse in [Integration layer](#).

Phase — 07-audiences-channels-boundaries

Directory: [07-audiences-channels-boundaries/](#)

Source: [07-audiences-channels-boundaries/01-channel-routing-and-two-world-model.md](#)

Channel routing — which truth belongs where

What this settles

Keep **live comportment / owned stable facts** cleanly separated from **paper trail / counsel / mediated writing** channels—mixing improvisational boasts with evidentiary lanes produces self-inflicted wounds.

Story / lens

Evaluative worlds parse **oral affect** distinct from **binder contents**; knowledge-work analogues echo **Slack heat vs ticket coolness** divergence. Emotional bait arriving live still answers better as **flattened administrative noun statements** than improvised trial closings. Sensitive phrasing meaningfully legal belongs with counsel review — this sheet names **routing buckets**, not substitutes counsel voice.

Moves

Sketch **quadrant** on paper per live conflict cluster: **Witness-visible behaviour • Short oral facts I own cleanly • Delegate to advisor/dossier • Forbidden improvisational story branches** — fill tranquilly offstage.

~**eight blended bait lines** read neutrally aloud — you answer first by **vocal channel label** (Arena A live demeanour vs Arena B written/counsel) stub before elaborated safe content.

Constraint: **never** rebuild full evidentiary architecture from fragile boast-memory when uncertain — anchor unknowns to advisement.

Neighbours

[Feed starvation habits](#)

Source: [07-audiences-channels-boundaries/02-starve-feed-and-amplify-discipline.md](#)

Starve noisy loops — refuse anxiety expansion of the record

What this settles

Recognise **feed behaviours** (silence panic stuffing, gossip amplification, diagnostic theatre, conspiracy tint) replacing them with **singular boundary** declarations or intentional redirects.

Story / lens

Anxiety equates **verbosity with clarity** despite asymmetric readership—creating receipts nobody sympathetic archives kindly. **Ethical ignore** contrasts **procedural minimum acknowledgement** particularly inside institutional mailboxes where silence equals signal misread. Hygiene: narrower CC lines, fewer reactive acknowledgements, skipping diagnostic performance for hostile galleries.

Moves

Document **five void-filler sentences historically deployed** — strike-through each — pair with **one humane boundary replacement line** spoken aloud until muscle recalls replacement first.

Silence endurance sits two clock minutes—tally hash marks per urge to narrate—density should decay across days though thoughts never need hit literal zero.

Role-play after answering hands anchor pocket/knee — **oral lock** until ally signals next cue — observe urge magnitude counts internal-only.

Accountability: partner certifies **no “oh by the way...”** postscript pollution block-wide.

Neighbours

[Channel routing anatomy](#)

Phase — 08-behaviour-as-signal

Directory: 08-behaviour-as-signal/

Source: 08-behaviour-as-signal/01-internal-filter-no-catalog-no-performance-self-work-talk.md

Self-work talk—filter, not catalogue

What this settles

When someone authoritative asks what you do to stay grounded, **how you phrase it** decides whether you read as credible versus auditioning for approval. This sheet is an **internal filter**: not line-by-line theatre, not a slick exam answer, not self-promotion dressed as humility.

You keep three bearings short:

1. **What** you actually do toward stability in roles that matter (especially around a child when that applies).
2. **How** it shows—calmer replies, clearer boundaries, fewer escalations—without unloading apps, coaches, acronyms, or your full reading stack.
3. **Why** it serves the dependent or stakeholder context (child first when that is the room), **not** why you deserve to win a dispute.

Evaluator-facing, **clinical**, and **court-oriented** channels shift tone slightly; shared rule stays: **compact, parental relevance, no backstage tour**.

See also [Two registers — private vs outward](#).

Story / lens

The persuasive unit remains **observable caregiving behaviour**, not rhetoric about your journey. Formal support (counselling, mediation, supervised services) deserves **accurate short labels only**—no dramatic chronology nobody asked for. When unsure whether to elaborate, **shorter beats clever**: one truthful general sentence, or only what is plainly verifiable and relevant.

Anchors you may weave sparingly

- **Parent-role aim**: clearer communication around conflict involving the child; **adult discord carried away from them** where reality allows; steadier tone; routines that are doable, not proclaimed perfection.
- **Why it matters**: the child gains someone **predictable enough to trust**, not proof you are morally right about the dispute.
- **Formal support**: if it exists and matches documentation—short accurate label only.
- **Exercise / movement**: optional **single** temperate line when it genuinely supports stress stability—sleep and energy, not trophy talk.
- **Weight / intimate health**: optional **only** when already on the agenda—otherwise silence usually wins.
- **Breathing / short regulation**: grounded tone; skip spiritual branding if the room hears it as image-craft.
- **Instead of jargon**: say **calmer wording under pressure**, **clearer framing**, **reading what questions are asking**—no packaged brand names.
- **Communication as substance**: clearer requests, slower escalation, appropriate tone—not a bibliography.

One-sentence bearings (adapt your words)

Shapes only—omit anything untrue:

- “I push to stay calmer and clearer under pressure—especially whenever something touches the kids.”
- “I try to carry adult clash away from the children and keep rhythm and wording steadier.”
- “When stress ramps up I’m working toward shorter replies and firmer footing so I’m more reliable.”

Five compact answers to “What are you doing for yourself?”

Pick **one** line suited to the room—not a choral read-through:

1. “I’m practising calmer, more consistent wording in anything that surrounds the kids—particularly when stakes spike.”

2. "Keeping kids out of friction between adults matters to me—I watch tone and keep routines realistic."
3. "Under strain I practise shorter clearer answers—so I'm steadier support around them."
4. "I'm sharpening what each question expects from me—and keeping my escalation low." (*Only if the context already tolerates analytic language.*)
5. Movement line—only if true: physical activity anchors my energy levels; wording work stays centred on parenting calm.

What to omit (common credibility leaks)

- **Tool catalogues:** forums, habit apps, sprawling webinars paraded like credentials.
- **Generative-chat confessional sessions** spun as substitutes for appointed counsel/specialists on case facts—never.
- **Manifest-reading lists**, module-completion flex, influencer grammar that reads like marketing—not stability evidence out loud.
- **Buzz labels** that sound tactical-combat-coded—prefer plain behavioural effects ("calmer phrasing").
- **Weight as vanity plot** unrelated to medically relevant threads.
- **Sport swagger** unrelated to stamina for caregiving—skip unless asked.
- **Long confessional autobiography** if nobody asked.
- **Validation fishing** from anonymous panels instead of professional channels.
- **Self-help identity theatre** ("deep work," "systems," "methodology")—swap for **calm, concrete, child-forward phrasing**.

Short rule when stuck

True enough, parent-relevant, supports the child **today**—no catalogue, no cleverness contest, no making self-improvement the headline story.

Naturalness under observation

Evaluators often care whether you **know the child as a person**—interests, ordinary time, small warmth without slogans. One **real** mini-story (situation → one feeling word → what you did → what the child needed), **under ~30–45 seconds**, then stop—no victory-lap tone; no "always perfect." See [Measurable stability and caregiving signals](#).

Moves

Low-frequency voice check (optional): at most twice weekly, record two variants—**stakeholder-safe** short line vs richer **trusted-friend** wording—and notice if the wider version adds recruiting or flex DNA.

Ban-list rehearsal: name channels that tempt identity flex (assistant stacks, course receipts, meme therapy). Pair each temptation with **one factual effect sentence**: "fewer sarcastic pings," "I cut threads before midnight escalation."

Self-scan: would a sceptical outsider still hear **factual stabilisation**—or stage presence?

Source: 08-behaviour-as-signal/02-two-registers-internal-speech-vs-shareable.md

Two registers — private candour versus outward humane clarity

What this settles

Keep **inside register** candid enough for strategising martyrdom away; outward register stays humane, factual, responsibly scoped—preventing hostility exports that immortalise catastrophically in writing.

Story / lens

Translating wrath into operational clarity differs from censorship: goal is halt **dual damage** cascade (self-worth collapse + dependents reading poison forever). Trusted channels (therapy paper, shredding journal voice) harbour raw verbs; transactional / institutional / offspring-facing corridors receive cooler nouns—not fake sweetness, workable precision. Crosswalk stability vocabulary also within [Measurable signals](#) + [Self-work filter rhetoric](#).

Moves

- **Ten bilingual pairs aloud** brutal interior sentence permissible vs outward compassionate-boundary sentence sharing identical strategic DNA.

- **Leak review** resurrect last provocative outbound message ⇒ highlight cruelties exported from hyperbolic inner monologue ⇒ rewrite solitary corrected humane line occupying same strategic goal.

Boundary: **nobody rebrands cruelty toward dependents rationalised via “authentic inner toughness.”**

Source: 08-behaviour-as-signal/03-measurable-stability-and-caregiving-signals-appendix.md

Observable stability fabric — caregiver & professional mirrors

What this settles

Name **witness-visible behavioural habits** you already embody or consciously install — punctuality choreography, neutrality around third parties audible to dependents, resisting triangulation relays through children—or workplace reliability analogues when caregiving specifics absent.

Story / lens

Reviewers extrapolate legitimacy less from lyrical autobiography than from **cyclical mundane integrity**: predictable cadence arrivals, restrained transfer logistics, tonal hygiene under micro-stress glimpses. **Self-rating ladders** quantify incremental +1 attainable weekly—not perfection cosplay. **Absence dependents** remap rows toward team reliability / documentation hygiene equivalents.

Moves

Craft ~**five behavioural rows outsiders could witness** ⇒ honest 0–3 scoreboard presently ⇒ choose **singular +1 attainable focus** practising seven-day horizon.

Deliver **sixty-ish second spoken synopsis** pragmatically describing what dependents receive without bribery melodrama overlays (audio optional critique).

Phase — 09-daily-mechanics

Directory: [09-daily-mechanics/](#)

Source: [09-daily-mechanics/01-universal-micro-ritual.md](#)

Daily micro ritual — breaths, digit, single move

What this settles

Before the first heavyweight contact chunk of the day, you run an automatic **triple breath**, **stress digit label**, **one reachable action sentence** so cognition-heavy arenas never start cold from improvised heroics.

Story / lens

The ritual stacks **regulated breathing**, **named arousal level**, and **microscopic executable move** upstream of reactive loops. Verification is behavioural integrity—not a moral score. The action sentence must point at something **observable** (send / not send / schedule / walk)—not abstraction alone.

Optional layering ties to [Three-layer operational mantra](#) without turning the mantra into theatre.

Moves

Keep a streak mark for days where the ritual completed **before** first serious interaction—mechanical repetition matters more than story.

Evening glance: today's sentence must have referred to a **bounded commitment** visible on a calendar or outbox—not only an intention.

Rough target once load rises: seven-day bare minimum streak before treating the ritual as optional.

Source: [09-daily-mechanics/02-morning-protocol-card.md](#)

Morning protocol card — daily operational start

Complete before first heavy contact of the day. Entire sequence: under 5 minutes.

Sequence

1. Triple breath (30 seconds)

Three slow breaths, each one longer than the previous. On the third exhale: shoulders drop, jaw unclenches.

Not meditation. Not a ritual you perform beautifully. A mechanical reset.

2. Stress digit (15 seconds)

Pick a number 1–5 right now:

- 1 = rested, clear, no background noise
- 2 = slightly tired or something low-grade running
- 3 = elevated — some stress present, manageable
- 4 = high load — external pressure, sleep deficit, conflict active
- 5 = overwhelmed or dysregulated — system is hot

Say the number aloud. Write it if you have a log.

If 4 or 5: today is a managed day, not a performance day. Adjust commitments accordingly. Do not pretend the number is lower.

3. Single reachable action (60 seconds)

Complete this sentence:

"Today, one bounded thing I will do is ____."

Rules for the sentence: - Observable: you can verify by end of day whether it happened - Reachable: possible with current energy level - Not abstract: "be calm" is not it. "Send that message before lunch" is.

Write it down or say it aloud. Both work. The act of stating it matters more than the medium.

Daily log (optional, high-value if maintained)

Date: _____
Stress digit: _____
One action: _____
Completed by EOD: Yes / No / Partial

Streak target: complete this before first serious contact on 7 consecutive days. After that it becomes background. Before that — track it mechanically.

Trigger map

If stress digit is...	Then...
1–2	Normal day, full engagement available
3	Useful signal. Note what's running. No action change needed.
4	Lighten scheduled commitments where possible. No difficult communications without preparation.
5	Reschedule non-urgent high-stakes interactions. Protect recovery window.

Integration

The action sentence links to [Three-layer operational mantra](#).

The stress digit feeds into [Evening review template](#) — compare morning digit to evening one. Pattern over weeks shows load trends before they become emergencies.

Phase — 10-drills-and-exercise-archive

Directory: `10-drills-and-exercise-archive/`

Source: `10-drills-and-exercise-archive/01-integration-layer-scenario-loops.md`

Integration layer — scenario-first landing

What this settles

Role-play blocks, timed turns, and written-conflict rehearsal are how this program **sticks**—not perpetual new prose. Repeated scenario sets confront accusations, chat ambushes, institutional tone, and fatigue until responses feel boringly clean rather than improvised.

Story / lens

Maintain **repeatable scenario clusters** you rotate deliberately:

- Overview + integration — how simulated weeks chain; neutral field notes after rough contact (fact, shape of response, one lever).
- Ten-minute skeleton — minimum viable rep when calendar is hostile.
- Provocation / accusation sets — short turns, zero insult mirroring, breath between clauses.
- Presence + reputation — gossip pressure, third-party audience, boringly clean on record.
- Written conflict — chat/email rhythm; fewer reactive paragraphs; bounded facts.
- Loved-one friction with competing interests — grief-friendly wording that still holds limits.
- Compromise under time pressure — when partial deals buy peace versus leak leverage.
- Helplessness / crisis — single next step when freeze appears; naming realistic threats vs learned spirals.
- Contact and warmth — humane gaze, steady tempo, without charisma masked as authenticity.

After each heavier block, tag **which folder** (01 – 14) picked up evidence—FAST typing, observer labelling, grounding—so gains attach to behaviour, not mood storytelling. Pair noisy sessions with **observer loop** material.

Moves

Pick **one** scenario cluster per week; complete its minimum reps; log a plain done/skipped line—essay optional.

After each intense rep, one line naming which unit skill moved (pause, technique routing, observer label, somatic reset).

Rebalance weekly: **attempted scenarios** should outrun **fresh pages skimmed**.

Source: `10-drills-and-exercise-archive/02-weekly-drill-schedule.md`

Weekly drill schedule — minimum viable reps

One scenario cluster per week. Complete its minimum reps. Log done/skipped — no essay required.

Design principle

Attempted scenarios must outrun fresh pages skimmed. Reading new material gives the feeling of progress. Drilling old material produces the actual progress.

Minimum viable session: **10–15 minutes**. If you have 30 — extend the hard items, don't add a new cluster.

Weekly cycle (4-week rotation)

Week 1 — Message classification + observer labelling

Goal: classification reflex under 2 seconds, observer-stable log from at least one real contact.

Day	Activity	Time	Log
Mon	Drill Set A — Message Classification	15 min	Done / Skipped
Wed	Drill Set B — same drill	15 min	Done / Skipped
Thu–Fri	Fill Observer daily log after one real contact	5 min	Done / Skipped
Sun	Weekly observer log scan — count observer-stable vs impulse	5 min	Done / Skipped

Week 1 minimum: 2 drill sessions + 1 observer log entry.

Week 2 — Communication under pressure: pause and structure

Goal: 2-second gap before first word, no filler syllables, 3-sentence limit per turn.

Day	Activity	Time	Log
Mon	Solo spoken reps — read 10 prompts from Set B aloud, pause 2 sec before each answer	10 min	Done / Skipped
Wed	Partner or voice-recorded session — 6 prompts, answer in 1–3 sentences max, then stop	15 min	Done / Skipped
Thu–Fri	Apply in one real interaction — note where silence felt uncomfortable	—	Note: __
Sun	Review: how many times did “...and another thing” or filler appear this week?	5 min	Count: __

Week 2 minimum: 1 solo rep session + 1 application in real contact.

Week 3 — Sustained pressure and compound accusations (Drill Set C)

Goal: refuse premises cleanly without mirroring insult, route compound accusations to single focus.

Day	Activity	Time	Log
Mon	Drill Set C — classify and route all 10 items	15 min	Done / Skipped
Wed	Spoken triad practice on 6 items: refuse premise → boundary sentence → behavioural pivot	15 min	Done / Skipped
Thu–Fri	If a difficult message arrives this week: classify before replying. Log it.	—	Done / Skipped
Sun	Note: which item type in Set C was hardest? Add to next week’s hard-item list.	5 min	Item: __

Week 3 minimum: 1 classification session + spoken triads on at least 3 items.

Week 4 — Integration and reset loop

Goal: run a full simulated interaction from start (observer pre-state) through contact through post-contact log.

Day	Activity	Time	Log
Mon	Morning protocol (stress digit + action sentence) — log it	3 min	Digit: __
Mon–Fri	Evening review template — 3 questions daily	5 min/day	Streak: __/5
Wed	Simulated heavy contact: partner reads from drill set C + D (create your own hard set), you respond live with: observe → route → 1–3 sentences → stop	20 min	Done / Skipped
Fri	Post-contact observer log from the simulated session	5 min	Done / Skipped
Sun	Month review: which skill moved most? What’s the hardest remaining cluster?	10 min	Skill: __

Week 4 minimum: 5-day evening review streak + 1 full simulated session.

Quarterly recalibration

After 4 weeks, answer:

- 1. Which drill felt routine? (evidence of skill building)
- 2. Which drill still felt uncomfortable every time? (priority for next cycle)
- 3. Has any real-world scenario type NOT appeared in drills? (add it to a custom set)

Adjust the next cycle based on gaps, not on what felt good to do.

Custom drill set D (yours to fill)

Add real messages, real scenarios, anonymized or fictional. The closer to your actual situation — the more useful the drill.

#	Message / scenario	Tag	Routing
1	—		
2	—		
3	—		
4	—		
5	—		

This set should grow over time. Hard items that keep appearing in your observer log become drill items here.

Phase — 11-reflection-evening-loop

Directory: 11-reflection-evening-loop/

Source: 11-reflection-evening-loop/01-three-evening-review-questions.md

Evening three questions — audit loop

What this settles

Replace rumination autopilot with three nightly probes that separate **facts**, **intrinsic stability duty**, and **impossible validation contracts**—so “reflection” does not disguise prosecuting yourself past midnight.

Story / lens

Brevity is the gate: overrun time budgets mean storytelling, not auditing. Aim answers tethered to **measurable stability** and child-forward / institution-neutral tone—not confessional melodrama for an imaginary sympathetic jury.

Daytime companion sheet: [After-talk reset and review](#).

Moves

Voice-journal capped at **ninety seconds** total:

1. **What fact changed objectively today** (one sentence factual layer)?
2. **What acted toward intrinsic stability**—not applause mining?
3. **Which audience was I proving toward—and can they actually supply the validation I demanded?**

If you blow the cap, restart tighter—shorter beats thorough.

Weekly: tag column 3 only (↑ / → / ↓) for honesty trend—no essay.

Source: 11-reflection-evening-loop/02-evening-review-template.md

Evening review template — 90 seconds, three questions

Run after dinner, not immediately after the hardest moment of the day. Distance is part of the tool.

The three questions

Answer each in one sentence. If you run over, restart shorter. Brevity is the gate — longer means you’re storytelling, not auditing.

Q1: What fact changed objectively today?

Not feeling. Not interpretation. What actually happened that is verifiable?

Example: “The court date was postponed to July.” / “I sent the document.” / “The conversation happened and lasted 20 minutes.”

Answer: __

Q2: What did I do today that was oriented toward stability — not toward proving something to someone?

Acts count. Thoughts and intentions do not.

Example: “I slept before midnight.” / “I walked instead of responding to that message.” / “I stayed on topic during the call.”

Answer: __

Q3: Which audience was I performing toward today — and can they actually supply the validation I was seeking?

Name the audience honestly. Then ask the hard question.

Example audience: “My lawyer.” “My ex-partner.” “Some imagined panel of judges.” “My own internal critic.”

Can they supply what I was seeking? Often: no. The partner cannot validate me. The lawyer evaluates procedure, not character. The panel doesn’t exist.

Audience: ____

Can they supply it: Yes / No / Partly

Weekly trend tracker

Once a week, look back at Q3 answers. Mark the pattern:

Week	Q3 direction	Trend
—	—	↑ more external / → stable / ↓ less external

No essay needed. One arrow per week.

Full daily log template

Date: _____
Morning digit: _____ (from morning protocol)
Evening digit: _____ (1-5 same scale)

Q1 — fact: _____
Q2 — stability: _____
Q3 — audience: _____ | Can supply: Y / N / Partly

One thing to carry forward tomorrow: _____

Warning signs in the answers

These patterns signal the review is being used for rumination, not audit:

- Q1 answer includes emotional language: “it was unfair that...”
- Q2 answer is about what you avoided feeling, not what you did
- Q3 answer names the same audience 5+ days in a row with no shift
- Review takes more than 5 minutes

If any of these appear — stop, reset the sequence, answer shorter.

Integration

Morning digit → compare to evening digit over 7 days → shows whether days tend to improve or worsen under current load.

Evening Q2 → feeds into [Observer daily log](#) — what was regulated, what slipped.

Source: 11-reflection-evening-loop/02-unblocking-paralysis-micro-forward-motion.md

Unblocking — dread typing and micro forward motion

What this settles

Separate **learned dread** from **evidence-backed threat**; when frozen, commit the smallest honest next executable step; keep crisis language from turning every fear into courtroom theatre.

Story / lens

Learned fear borrows catastrophic imagery from older loops; **realistic** hazards belong on **professional routes**, not solo rhetorical marathons. When planning collapses into infinite research, compress to **one truthful next physical or administrative move**. Pair physiological spin with **regulation somatic** work **before** you argue yourself in circles.

Moves

List ten anxieties; mark **L** (learned spiral) versus **R** (material hazard)—**R** items need external help, not self-debate alone.

Blocked more than ~30 minutes on a task → **five-minute** honest entry only—timer honoured; log done versus stopped.

Mind loops absolutes → return to **somatic resets**, then cognition.

During a declared block week, ship **at least one** forward micro daily.

Phase — 12-active-life-design

Directory: [12-active-life-design/](#)

Source: [12-active-life-design/01-building-life-offensive-layer-overview.md](#)

Building-life offensive layer — when the fire is no longer everyday

What this settles

“**Offense**” here names **deliberate energy allocation**—relational filters, ROI, option menus—not winning arguments. You also notice when defence-only loops ([regulation & recovery](#), institutional stress hygiene, reactive communication habits) still eat the calendar, so “life design” would be insulting noise on top.

Story / lens

Survival / defence lowers damage on wrong battlegrounds; **offence** names where relationship and vitality actually compound. Readiness often shifts from constant fight-or-flight toward having attention for **relational ROI** without melodrama, while still running [conflict decision sequencing](#) so every poke does not default to open war.

Practical threads: tighten **people filters**, measure **relational ROI**, **feed** workable alliances, **widen options** before cornered feeling, use **fast commit** rules on reversible choices, catch **patterns** that yolk you back into pure-defence burnout—moral grievance loops, apology theatre without proportional repair.

Carve deliberate [positive bandwidth](#) alongside conflict sequencing so siege posture does not devour hobbies, friendships, or future arcs.

If themes feel unreachable, linger with regulation/recovery work, [interpretive hygiene](#), observer tools, and conflict sequencing until baseline smoke clears.

Moves

One line each: today’s stability bottleneck / whether life-design framing feels aspirational or insulting—if insulting, park offence work.

Pick **one outward behaviour that widens healthy options or depth**—coffee with a trusted colleague, restoring a neglected logistics channel, politely narrowing a draining contact—and **calendar it**, not as aspiration alone.

Source: [12-active-life-design/02-conflict-decision-sequence-flag-pointers.md](#)

Conflict decision sequencing and flag cues

What this settles

Internalise a short pipeline: **assess importance / risk / meaningful goal** → **pattern class** → **engage / minimal / distance / exit** → **silent midstream checkpoint**—without mistaking autopilot (people-pleasing, counterattack) for strategy.

Pair with proactive energy framing when habitual avoidance masquerades as peace: [Building-life offensive overview](#).

Story / lens

The sequence runs classification first, then situation-type routing, then discrete stance, then conversation hygiene—**mid-conversation audits** flag slow bleeds early. When recurring conflict scripts flare, tighten routing with neighbouring communication and literacy sheets; when the habitual error is **always** choosing battle instead of building alternatives, lean harder on offence-layer option work—not louder engagement by default.

Moves

Twenty scenarios voiced aloud: final word **only** mode tag **ENG / MIN / DIS / EX** first pass—second pass one tactical sentence each.

Live contentious calls: silent vibrate cue every interval—each buzz asks *still toward purpose? draining faster than informing?* If no → downgrade mode.

Across a deliberate month, catch **early unnecessary engagement** at least twice weekly before it metastasises.

Source: 12-active-life-design/03-positive-life-bandwidth-social-identity-and-joy.md

Positive life bandwidth — friendships, hobbies, identity outside the feud

What this settles

Long conflict can **colonise identity** until every hobby, friendship spike, or future glance routes through courtroom gravity. Practical reclamation chooses **explicit bandwidth** for life not defined by adversarial narrative.

Touches **social rebuilding, friendship maintenance, hobby scaffolding, identity outside conflict, future planning, joy scheduling**, and **meaning anchors**—small enough to honour realistic custody/work load.

Story / lens

This extends **building-life offence overview**—the offensive layer stalls if “offense” only means escalation muscles. Humans need reservoirs not optimized for hostility: warmth, novelty, competency elsewhere, horizons past the next procedural date.

Siege physiology still matters—pair joyous claims with **recovery engineering** honesty so schedules don’t become fantasy.

Moves

Quarterly **relational audit**: whom you actually texted vs whom you theoretically value—invite one humane reconnection gesture if drift shames without self-attack.

Hobby mortar: ninety-minute weekly protected slab—low skill welcome (walk + camera, paperback chunk, tactile craft).

Compose **three identity sentences** untouched by feud keywords (“teacher,” “neighbor,” “mountain nerd,” ...) spoken aloud occasionally.

Calendar **micro future marker** ninety days ahead non-adversarial (trip deposit, certification, mundane upgrade).

Weekly **scheduled joy** (music block, tactile meal, deliberate comedy)—calendar truth > aspiration.

Volunteer/service **meaning wedge** optionally—only if resentment-proof and logistically sane.

Friction check: shrinking everything when spike hits—OK temporarily; forbid **months-long** abandonment without reassessment dialogue with trusted ally or therapist.

Neighbours

[Building-life offence overview](#) · [Conflict sequencing](#)

Phase — 13-professional-work-load

Directory: 13-professional-work-load/

Source: 13-professional-work-load/01-professional-relationship-under-pressure-overview.md

Professional relationships under stacked stress

What this settles

Hold **steady professional conduct** while private turbulence and asymmetric workplace risk coexist—leaning on **trace discipline**, **narrow channels**, and **task clarity** instead of improvised dominance theatre.

Story / lens

Classic attractor: private overload + probing office dynamics + lopsided downside (income trajectory, reputational dossiers touching other processes). Winning the conversational trophy often costs more than it returns; the metric shifts to **calm channels**, ticketed written trails, and refusing motivational autobiographies for colleagues auditioning gossip.

After volatile meetings, draft **five-line factual bullets** first (*facts • commitments • delegated • timeline owners*) **before** any emotional appendix—ordering keeps artefacts legible weeks later.

If overload is mostly logistical, pair refusal language with **operational stance** pacing and **audiences / channels** routing; escalate through HR/policy paths aligned with your locality (non-specific legal advice here).

Moves

Harvest **five** concrete workplace behaviours to rotate weekdays—deferral wording, stakeholder map edits, restrained reputation habits, documentation triggers closing loops without CC theatre.

Rough meeting closes → factual recap within minutes wherever appropriate—process emotion on a safer channel consciously.

Across a deliberate month-long watch (if reactive “reply-all adrenaline” historically leaked), visibly trend reactive broadcast downward.

Phase — 14-appendix-custody-expert-proceedings

Directory: 14-appendix-custody-expert-proceedings/

Source: 14-appendix-custody-expert-proceedings/01-expert-session-topic-map-and-mini-brief.md

Expert / safeguarding-style scenario prep — execution lab

Legal alignment with counsel remains mandatory—not a substitute for it.

What this settles

Cover the **topic map**, rehearse a **compact brief skeleton**, maintain **prep tone**: steady volume, chronological clarity, resisting prosecutorial tangents at absent third parties—when counsel approves the plan.

Story / lens

Compress what evaluators notice before substantive questions arrive—biography without overshare, restrained conflict description that keeps children forward, pragmatic translation of tests without jargon shields, contingency language when sleep or logistics crater. Tie tempo discipline to neighbouring **communication under pressure** units.

Doorway autobiography: aim **under ~25 seconds** so dependable caregiving arcs lead, not applause arcs. Invite counsel critique whenever stakes justify it.

Moves

Print five topical headers (**biography, conflict/process, evaluations/tests, direct observation cues, child's daily picture, logistical execution**)—mark confidence high/med/low; anything low earns one recorded aloud pass.

Swap placeholder biography lines for a truthful factual arc, record audio, shave filler—closing thrust favours stability trajectory where context fits counsel guidance.

Deliver three index-card crises aloud—maximum two declarative sentences, mandatory stop afterward; coach flags volume creep.

Dry-run until three consecutive video self-reviews stay free of speed and volume creep.

Source: 14-appendix-custody-expert-proceedings/02-questions-cheatsheets-knjige-reading.md

Question banks, cheatsheets, optional reading — oral rehearsal harness

What this settles

Dense custody-facing prompts belong as **spoken inventory**: draw lines, assign a communication technique family, answer out loud—not silent highlighting.

Story / lens

Usually four layers stack:

1. **Long-form bank** — broad coverage; pull random batches (~5 lines), rotate techniques mapped in **communication under pressure, situation literacy**, and—when rehearsals slide into courtroom-in-skull narration—brief passes through **interpretive traps**. Aim disciplined clips (≤45 s): pause audible?, stop honoured?, monotone dignity?, no insult echo?
2. **Short warm-up bank** — micro-set when the appointment horizon eats prep time.
3. **Term / operator cheatsheet** — same-day skim: read bullets slowly once, immediately answer **two improvised surprise lines without rewriting** the crib mid-stream—keeps memory skeletal instead of edit-anxiety.

4. **Emergency orientation card** — under-one-minute skim at the door—orientation only; no cramming fresh script.

Separate track: **damage-control narrative**—blunt outline → trimmed thirty-to-sixty-second version stressing **facts, logistics, stability for the child**—avoid accidental manifestos.

Trade paperbacks in a general pile can lend metaphor; they **do not replace** spoken bank reps ahead of procedural interviews.

Technique shorthand throughout this trace maps to 05-communication-under-pressure routing cards, **situation-literacy tagging**, plus **interpretive hygiene** when stories outrun facts.

Moves

Weekly: pull seven unseen lines from the long bank—each earns spoken answer ≤ 45 s plus technique ID; archive audio only if counsel or coaching benefits.

Morning-of: read cheatsheet bullets aloud slowly once → **two surprise follow-ups aloud immediately** → no mid-session page fiddling.

Track countable oral repetitions—they should slope **up** as calendar pressure rises, not shelf time.

Phase — 15-identity-and-narrative-reconstruction

Directory: 15-identity-and-narrative-reconstruction/

Source: 15-identity-and-narrative-reconstruction/01-inherited-narrative-audit.md

Inherited narrative audit — what is mine, what was installed

Not all beliefs you carry about yourself are yours. Some were installed — through repetition, pressure, or long-term dynamics in which someone else defined who you are. This audit separates them.

Why this is necessary

When someone tells you who you are often enough and loudly enough — you start to believe them. Especially if that person was close, if you were exhausted, or if you were in a position where defending yourself consumed all available energy.

The result: you carry a story about yourself that isn't yours. You act from it, make decisions from it, sometimes defend it even when it harms you.

The goal of this audit is not to convince you that you are perfect. The goal is to give you freedom through **distinction** — what is mine, what is not — so you can choose what you keep.

Part 1 — Belief inventory

Write your answers to these questions. You're writing for yourself, not for an audience. There are no correct answers.

What do I believe about myself in these areas:

As a parent: _____
As a partner: _____
As a person in conflict: _____
As someone who makes mistakes: _____
My worth: _____
My stability: _____
My capability: _____

Do not filter. Write what you actually believe — even if it embarrasses you.

Part 2 — Origin test

For each belief you wrote, ask these three questions:

Question A: Where does this belief come from?

- ☐ My own experience — I see this in my behaviour over time
- ☐ Someone else's assessment — someone told me this, repeatedly or forcefully
- ☐ Combination — partly mine, partly absorbed
- ☐ I don't know

Question B: When did I start believing this?

Before a specific person / situation: _____
During or after: _____

If you held this belief before — it's likely yours or older, not installed by that person. If it appeared during or after a specific dynamic — that is a signal.

Question C: Who benefits from me believing this?

Me (it makes me better, holds me accountable): _____
Someone else (it weakens my position, justifies their actions): _____

This is not a conspiracy theory. This is a practical question: does this belief work for you or against you?

Part 3 — Most commonly installed beliefs (recognise if any are yours)

These are beliefs frequently installed through prolonged conflictual dynamics or toxic relationships. Read the list. Mark those you recognise in yourself.

[] "I am too emotional / unstable."
[] "I can't trust my own read of situations."
[] "I'm always the one who ruins things."
[] "My needs are too much."
[] "The children would be better off without my influence."
[] "I'm not good enough as a parent / partner / person."
[] "Others see clearly – I'm the biased party."
[] "My anger / sadness / fear proves I'm in the wrong."
[] "When I'm happy, it's a brief pause – I'm fundamentally a bad person."
[] "I have to try twice as hard to prove I'm normal."

For each one marked: apply the test from Part 2.

Part 4 — Separation

For beliefs that are **installed** (not yours), write:

Belief: _____
What is actually true in this (if anything): _____
What is exaggerated, distorted, or untrue: _____
What would I say about this if I were rested, safe, and free of pressure? _____

That last answer — “what I would say without pressure” — is the starting point for your own narrative.

Part 5 — Operational rule

When you receive a message, comment, or legal document that activates one of those installed beliefs:

1. Recognise: “this is targeting an installed story about me”
2. Do not defend against the installed belief — defending it confirms it
3. Return to your own narrative (file 03 of this phase)
4. If a response is needed — respond from your story, not theirs

Integration

Run this audit once thoroughly, then revisit every few months or after an intense period of pressure.

The results feed into → [Building your own narrative](#)

Recognising an installed belief in real time → [Observer daily log](#) — add to Story channel: “this is their story / this is my story”

Mindfulness as an observational tool — a thought is not a fact

Mindfulness here is not meditation in the classical sense. It is training one specific skill: noticing a thought before it becomes your reality.

What this does

Between “someone says you are bad” and “I believe I am bad” there is a gap.

Mindfulness practice builds that gap. The wider the gap — the more space you have to choose what to do with that. The narrower it is — the more automatically you absorb someone else’s narrative as your own truth.

This connects directly to the [Observer loop](#) — but goes deeper: not just labelling in the moment, but training yourself to recognise a thought as an **event in the mind**, not a **description of reality**.

The core distinction

Automatic mode	Mindful mode
“I am a bad parent.”	“I’m having the thought that I’m a bad parent.”
“This is going to end badly.”	“I notice a thought that this will end badly.”
“I am not good enough.”	“This thought has shown up again.”

The shift is not denial. You are not saying “that isn’t true.” You are saying: “this is a thought — I can examine it rather than swallow it.”

Practice 1 — Thought as a cloud (5 minutes daily)

Intended for: morning or before a difficult interaction.

Steps:

1. Sit quietly. Close your eyes if you can.
2. Notice the first thought that appears. Don’t generate it — just wait.
3. When it arrives, label it internally: *“Here is a thought.”*
4. Visualise it as a cloud passing across the horizon. You don’t push it away — you don’t hold it either.
5. Wait for the next one. Repeat.

What you will notice: - Thoughts arrive uninvited - They don’t all carry equal weight - When you don’t press against them or defend from them, they pass faster

Log (optional):

Date: _____
Loudest thought today: _____
I noticed it: immediately / with a delay / not at all

Practice 2 — Body scan as an early signal (3 minutes)

Intended for: before, during, or after a difficult interaction.

An installed narrative arrives with a physical signal — before the thought becomes a sentence, the body already knows.

Steps:

1. Stop. Three slow breaths.
2. Scan from feet to head — where is there tension?

Jaw: relaxed / tight
Shoulders: relaxed / raised
Chest: open / constricted
Stomach: relaxed / tense
Hands: open / clenched

1. Which part of the body is most activated?
2. Ask: “What is running in my mind right now that is creating this?”

Why: Installed narratives have a characteristic physical signature. When you recognise it — you have 2–3 seconds before you respond automatically. That is enough.

Practice 3 — Separation sentence (real time)

Intended for: when you notice that someone’s word, message, or situation is activating you.

Internal sentence (never aloud):

“I am having the thought that [X]. This is a thought, not a fact. I can examine it.”

Examples: - “I am having the thought that I was unfair to the children. This is a thought, not a fact.” - “I am having the thought that I am not good enough. This is a thought, not a fact.” - “I am having the thought that everything will fall apart. This is a thought, not a fact.”

Important: You are not telling yourself you are perfect. You are telling yourself this deserves examination, not automatic acceptance.

After the sentence — apply the test from [Inherited narrative audit](#): is this mine or absorbed?

Practice 4 — Weekly mindfulness log (10 minutes weekly)

Week: _____

Most frequent thought about myself this week: _____

Origin (mine / absorbed / unknown): _____

How many times did I notice it BEFORE it pulled me: ____/____

Situation where the gap was largest (noticed, did not react automatically):

Situation where it pulled me without awareness:

What would help next week: _____

Integration into the existing system

Mindfulness practice does not run separately — it layers into what you already do:

Existing tool	Mindfulness layer
Observer daily log — Story channel	Add: “is this story mine or absorbed?”
Morning protocol — stress digit	Add Practice 2 (body scan) before writing the number
Message classification drill	Before classifying: Practice 3 — separation sentence
Evening review	Q1 answer: is this a fact, or a thought about a fact?

What this is not

- Not suppressing thoughts

- Not positive thinking
- Not ignoring problems
- Not a spiritual practice (unless you want it to be)

This is **training one precise skill**: noticing an automatic thought before it becomes your identity.

Source: 15-identity-and-narrative-reconstruction/03-own-narrative-construction.md

Building your own narrative — a story from evidence, not from hope

Your own story is not built from affirmations you don't believe. It is built slowly, from concrete evidence out of real experience, while the installed narrative gradually loses ground.

Why affirmations don't work (when someone has convinced you that you are bad)

If someone tells you “you're a great parent” and you deeply believe you're not — your mind rejects it. It is too far from the installed belief.

What works is something more modest and precise: an **evidence log** — a record of concrete moments that align with who you actually are, without exaggeration.

Not “I am a great parent.” But: “today I sat with my child for 20 minutes and was present. That happened.”

The accumulation of those records, over time, becomes the foundation of a new narrative — grounded in real experience, not in wishful thinking.

Part 1 — Definition: who you are by behaviour

A story about yourself cannot begin from feeling (“I feel like a good person”) or from someone else's approval (“they say I'm...”). It begins from **behaviour that is visible and repeatable**.

Fill this in:

Three things I do consistently, without an audience:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Three values I would recognise in my own behaviour – even in difficult periods:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

One thing I know to be true about myself, even when pressure pushes me to forget it:

These are starting points. They don't need to be grand — the more concrete they are, the more resistant they are to external pressure.

Part 2 — Evidence log (daily practice, 2 minutes)

Every day, one sentence. Concrete, not emotional.

Format:

“[Date] — [What you did / how you behaved] — this is consistent with [value].”

Examples:

"12.03.2026 — Waited for my child to finish their sentence before responding. Patience."

"14.03.2026 — Did not respond to a provocative message today. Chose not to engage. Self-control."

"17.03.2026 — Acknowledged a mistake to the children directly and without drama. Accountability."

Rules: - One entry — no more, no less - Only what actually happened - Do not write anything you are not certain is true - Do not skip days when things were hard — those days especially have something worth recording

Log format (weekly review):

Week: _____

Monday: _____

Tuesday: _____

Wednesday: _____

Thursday: _____

Friday: _____

Saturday: _____

Sunday: _____

Which value appeared most often this week: _____

Which value was harder to show: _____

Part 3 — Identity statement (not an affirmation — a claim from evidence)

After 2–3 weeks of the evidence log, write three sentences about yourself in first person.

Rules: - Each must be supported by at least one concrete example from the log - No superlatives ("I am the best") - No direct refutation of someone else's story ("I am not what they say") - Written about behaviour, not about feelings

Examples:

"I am someone who remains present for my children even when exhausted. I showed this on [concrete moment]."

"I make decisions from accountability, not from fear — even when that costs me in the short term. I showed this when [concrete moment]."

"I know the difference between a mistake and a character defect. I make mistakes, correct them when I can, and move on."

Write your three:

1. _____
Evidence: _____

2. _____
Evidence: _____

3. _____
Evidence: _____

These statements are your foundation when external pressure tries to push you back into the installed narrative.

Part 4 — Protecting the narrative under pressure

The installed narrative returns most easily during: - Physical exhaustion - Unexpected attack (written, verbal, or official) - Silence — when there is no external validation for an extended period - After a mistake

For each of these moments, prepare one anchor — a short sentence you return to.

When exhausted, my anchor is: _____

When under attack, my anchor is: _____

When validation is absent, my anchor is: _____

When I make a mistake, my anchor is: _____

An anchor is not false comfort. An anchor is a sentence grounded in evidence from the log — something you know to be true even when you don't feel that it is.

Part 5 — Separating from someone else's story in real time

When you notice that someone's words are activating an installed narrative (using the mindfulness practice from file 02):

1. **Pause** — do not respond immediately
2. **Name it**: "this is targeting an installed story about me"
3. **Anchor**: say your identity statement to yourself
4. **Classify the message**: I / P / H (from [Message classification drill](#))
5. **Respond from your narrative**, not from theirs

Example sequence:

You receive a message: "You were never a stable parent."

Pause. → "This is targeting the installed narrative." → Anchor: "I remain present for my children." → Classification: P (provocation) → Routing 6 (refuse premise) + Routing 2 (care-forward) → Respond with one factual sentence or do not respond.

How this develops over time

Weeks 1-2: Audit (file 01) — understand what is not yours
Weeks 3-4: Mindfulness (file 02) — practise the gap between thought and reaction
Weeks 5+: Evidence log + identity statements — build your own foundation
Month 2+: Anchors become automatic, installed narrative loses force

This is not a fast process. The installed narrative was built over years — your own takes months. What matters is regularity, not speed.

Integration

Evidence log entries → [Evening review Q2](#): "what did I do toward stability today" maps directly to the log.

Anchors → [Morning protocol](#): if stress digit is 4-5, read one anchor before the first difficult interaction.

Identity statements → when the observer loop catches you in a Story channel that is not yours — return to these statements.

Phase — 16-cbt-practical-tools

Directory: 16-cbt-practical-tools/

Source: 16-cbt-practical-tools/01-activated-state-protocol.md

Activated state protocol — when something hits you

What this is and why it works

When something activates you — a message, a comment, a situation, a conversation — your brain shifts into defensive mode. In that state you do not think clearly, you do not assess accurately, and everything that comes out of you in the next few minutes is likely coming from fear or anger, not from genuine reasoning.

The problem is not that you get activated. The problem is that in an activated state you make decisions, send messages, and form conclusions about yourself and the situation that are not accurate — and that stay with you long after the moment has passed.

CBT (cognitive behavioural therapy) has a straightforward mechanism for this: **between the event and the reaction, insert a structured step that slows down and examines the thought before it becomes a belief or an action.** You are not eliminating the emotion — you are examining it.

This is not for every day. This is for moments when you notice you are activated and a thought is circling or pulling at you.

When to use this protocol

Use it when you recognise at least one of the following: - You received a message or comment that hit you and you have a strong impulse to respond immediately - One thought about yourself or the situation keeps returning and you cannot release it - You feel strong shame, anger, fear, or emptiness connected to a specific situation - Something that happened an hour, a day, or a week ago is still “working” in you

Protocol — three steps

Step 1 — Immediately (0–2 minutes)

Put down the phone or close the laptop. Do not respond to anything.

Set a timer for **20 minutes**.

During this time: do not re-read the message, do not talk about the situation, do not analyse. Just wait. This is not weakness — it is technique. The brain in acute activation cannot examine objectively. 20 minutes changes the chemistry enough for the thought to become accessible.

If it is urgent and you must do something: write one neutral sentence that contains no position. “I see your message, I’ll respond shortly.” That is all.

Step 2 — After 20 minutes (10–15 minutes)

Open this file. Answer the questions in order, in writing — not in your head. Writing slows down and concretises a thought in a way that thinking alone cannot.

Question 1: What exactly happened?

Write only the event — no interpretation, no “because”, no “which means”. One or two sentences.

Example: “I received a message saying I was not present for my child last week.”

Not this: “I received a false accusation designed to paint me as a bad parent.” — this is already interpretation, not event.

Your answer: __

Question 2: What was my first automatic thought?

Write it literally, exactly as it came — even if it seems irrational or shameful. It is there. Better to see it than to push it down.

Example: “Maybe they’re right. Maybe I really am not enough.”

Example: “They’re doing this deliberately to destroy me in court.”

Example: “I cannot take this anymore.”

Your automatic thought: ____

Question 3: How strong is the emotion? (0–10)

Name the emotion as precisely as you can and give it a number.

“I feel bad” is not enough — bad is too broad. The mind does not know what to do with it.

Emotions common in these situations: **fear** (something bad will happen), **anger** (injustice, attack), **shame** (maybe they’re right about me), **sadness** (loss, helplessness), **anxiety** (uncertainty, what will happen next).

Example: “Shame — 8/10. Some anger — 5/10.”

Your emotion and number: ____

Question 4: Does this thought speak about the event, or about who I am?

This is the key question. There are two types of automatic thoughts:

Type A — thought about the situation: “This message is untrue.” / “This is a pressure tactic.” → May be accurate, may not be — but it speaks about the event, not about you.

Type B — thought about identity: “I am not enough.” / “I always ruin things.” / “I am a bad parent.” → This is an installed narrative that the event has activated. It is not the same as assessing the event.

If your automatic thought is Type B — it deserves specific attention in the following questions.

Your answer (Type A / Type B / both): ____

Question 5: What is the evidence FOR this thought? What is the evidence AGAINST?

This is the heart of the CBT approach. You are not asking “is this true?” — you are asking “what is the actual evidence?”

Fill both columns. If you skip one side — the exercise does not work.

Evidence FOR this thought	Evidence AGAINST this thought
—	—
—	—
—	—

Example for the thought “I am not enough as a parent”:

FOR	AGAINST
I didn’t call my child for two days last week	Every week I have a routine with my child that has worked for years
I sometimes raise my voice	I attended every school event this year
We haven’t talked about the problems they’re having at school	My child comes to me when something is difficult

Important: evidence must be concrete and verifiable — not feelings (“I feel like a bad parent”) but actual events and behaviours.

Question 6: What would a person who respects me say, having seen the same evidence?

Not someone who flatters you. Not someone who attacks you. Someone with genuine goodwill who would be honest.

What would they say about your automatic thought?

Example: “They would say that a few lapses don’t define the whole picture. That the effort is visible. That the perfect parent is a myth.”

Your answer: ____

Question 7: What is the balanced thought — the one that includes both sides?

Not optimistic. Not pessimistic. Accurate, as much as you can be.

Example: “I have lapses as a parent, and I also have things I do well and consistently. One message does not describe the whole.”

Your balanced thought: ____

Question 8: How strong is the emotion now? (0–10)

Same scale as before — what is the number now?

Emotion and number: ____

If it dropped by at least 2–3 points: the protocol worked. The emotion has not disappeared — it has shifted into something you can function from.

If it has not dropped: that is normal. Sometimes a second pass is needed, or the thought is more complex and warrants work with a therapist. It is not failure — it is information.

Step 3 — Decision about response

Now, from this state, decide:

- Does this need a response? (Not always necessary)
 - If yes — what is one sentence grounded in facts, not in emotion?
 - If no — what do I do instead? (Use [Reset protocol](#) or [Observer log](#))
-

Three worked examples

Example 1 — Message with accusation

Situation: Received a message: “The child tells me that when you’re with them you’re always on your phone and not paying attention.”

Automatic thought: “Maybe I really am like that. Maybe I don’t see how much I neglect my child.”

Emotion before: Shame 7/10, anxiety 6/10.

Type of thought: Type B — speaks about identity.

Evidence FOR	Evidence AGAINST
I sometimes check my phone when we’re together	Every weekend we do an activity my child chooses
I once cancelled an outing because of work	My child tells me what’s happening at school every day
—	When my child asks for attention, I put my phone away

What someone who respects me would say: “Every parent checks their phone sometimes. The question is overall presence, not perfection. The overall picture is not neglect.”

Balanced thought: “I have moments when I am not fully present, and I also have many moments when I am. This message describes one aspect, not the whole.”

Emotion after: Shame 3/10, anxiety 3/10.

Decision: Will not respond to the message today. Next week I will consciously keep my phone in my pocket for the entire time with my child.

Example 2 — Thought circling before sleep

Situation: No external trigger — but the thought “I’m not good enough” is circling before sleep.

Automatic thought: “Everyone else is functioning better. I am barely surviving.”

Emotion before: Sadness 8/10, listlessness 6/10.

Type of thought: Type B — identity + comparison.

Evidence FOR	Evidence AGAINST
Last week I didn't finish an important task	This month I managed to take my child to every scheduled appointment
I feel exhausted most days	I have not missed a single work deadline in the past three months
—	I have been through a period that would exhaust anyone

What someone who respects me would say: “You are functioning under pressure that most people could not sustain. ‘Barely surviving’ in these circumstances is actually surviving — which is not nothing.”

Balanced thought: “I am exhausted and it is affecting my functioning. I am still functioning. This is not a state that describes who I am — it describes the current pressure.”

Emotion after: Sadness 4/10, listlessness 3/10.

Decision: No action tonight. Tomorrow morning — one item from the morning protocol.

Example 3 — After a difficult formal meeting

Situation: A meeting with a lawyer / mediator / institution where you were under pressure and did not say everything you intended.

Automatic thought: “I showed myself badly again. I’m not capable of defending myself when it matters.”

Emotion before: Anger (at self) 7/10, frustration 8/10.

Type of thought: Type B — capability + identity.

Evidence FOR	Evidence AGAINST
I didn't say X that I had planned	I stayed calm throughout the entire meeting
I accepted one premise I shouldn't have	I asked one important question that changed the direction
I forgot a key document	I arrived prepared with material

What someone who respects me would say: “You entered a difficult meeting under pressure. Not everything went perfectly and you didn’t sink either. One poor showing does not define capability.”

Balanced thought: “This meeting did not go as I wanted. I have things to improve. That is concrete information for next time — not evidence about who I am.”

Emotion after: Anger 3/10, frustration 4/10.

Decision: Write notes on what I would do differently — for preparation before the next meeting. Not rumination.

Most common mistakes when using this

Mistake 1: Using the protocol in the hot moment It does not work. The brain is not accessible. Wait at least 20 minutes.

Mistake 2: Skipping the evidence AGAINST column “There is nothing AGAINST” — almost never true. If you cannot find anything, that is a signal you are still too activated, not that there is no evidence.

Mistake 3: Writing feelings instead of evidence “I feel like a bad parent” is not evidence. “I missed the agreed appointment on Tuesday” is evidence.

Mistake 4: A balanced thought that is just optimistic “Actually I’m great and everything is fine” — that is not a balanced thought, that is a defence. A balanced thought includes what did not go well.

Source: 16-cbt-practical-tools/02-recurring-thought-protocol.md

Recurring thought protocol — when the same thought will not stop

What this is and why it differs from the activated state protocol

There are two kinds of difficult thoughts:

Kind 1 — Reactive thought: something happened, you are not present, your brain reacts. For that there is the [Activated state protocol](#).

Kind 2 — Recurring thought: no concrete trigger, but the same thought keeps returning. Before sleep. In the shower. While driving. In the silence between situations. No new event — but the thought is always there, slowly draining energy.

Recurring thoughts are more dangerous than reactive ones because they have no clear trigger to signal that you should address them. They work quietly, in the background, and gradually shape how you see yourself and your situation — almost without you noticing.

This protocol is for that second kind.

How to recognise a recurring thought

Ask yourself: - Does this thought come every day, or multiple times a week, without a specific cause? - Do you already sense how the thought begins the moment you have a little silence? - Do you try to shake it off or stay busy to avoid feeling it? - Has this thought existed for months or years?

Two or more yes answers — this is a recurring thought and it warrants this protocol.

Protocol — five steps

Step 1 — Name the thought precisely (5 minutes)

Recurring thoughts are often vague — “something is wrong with me”, “this will not end well”, “I am not good enough”. That vagueness gives them power, because you cannot examine something that has not been precisely formulated.

Write the thought as a concrete statement. Do not paraphrase — write it literally, as it arrives.

Vague (not this): “I have a feeling that something is off with me.”

Precise (this): “I believe I am fundamentally a bad person and that others have seen this.”

Vague: “I worry about the future.”

Precise: “I believe the court will rule against me and I will lose contact with my child.”

Vague: “I feel worthless.”

Precise: “I believe I am not worthy of love and that everyone around me would be better off without me.”

Your precise thought: ____

Step 2 — Classify the thought (3 minutes)

Once you have the precise formulation, ask yourself:

Is this thought a prediction, an assessment, or an identity statement?

Type	Description	Example
Prediction	About what will happen in the future	“The court will rule against me.”
Assessment	About what something means or its value	“What I did is unacceptable.”
Identity statement	About who I am as a person	“I am a bad parent / bad person / a failure.”

Why classification matters: - Predictions can be tested against reality — what do the actual facts say about the future? - Assessments can be nuanced — one behaviour ≠ total worth - Identity statements are the most vulnerable to installed narratives — they almost always call for an audit from [file 01 of phase 15](#)

Type of your thought: ____

Step 3 — Examine the thought (10–15 minutes)

The questions differ depending on the type of thought.

If it is a PREDICTION:

Q1: What is this prediction based on? List concrete pieces of evidence that support it — actual events only, not feelings.

Q2: What evidence speaks against it or reduces its probability?

Q3: How many times in the past have you predicted a similar outcome and been right? How many times wrong?

Our minds are biased prediction machines — we systematically overestimate negative outcomes. This question asks you to check your own prediction track record.

Q4: If the prediction comes true — what would you do? Have you survived difficult things before?

This is not optimism. This is a realistic assessment of capacity.

Q5: What is the more realistic version of this prediction, based on all the evidence?

If it is an ASSESSMENT:

Q1: What specifically am I assessing as unacceptable / bad / a failure? Write the specific event or behaviour — not the general picture.

Q2: Does this single behaviour or event describe the whole?

The mind under distress makes generalisations — one event becomes “always”, “never”, “everyone”, “nothing”. Write what would be a more accurate formulation.

Instead of: “I wasn’t present for my child.” More accurate: “On that Tuesday I was not as present as I wanted to be.”

Q3: What standard would you apply to another person in the same situation?

We are almost always harder on ourselves than on others. Write how you would assess another person in an identical situation with identical circumstances.

Q4: What would be a fair assessment — one that includes context and the whole picture?

If it is an IDENTITY STATEMENT:

This is the most complex type. Before examining the thought here — run the [Inherited narrative audit](#) to establish whether this statement is yours or installed.

If you have already done the audit, or if you are uncertain, continue:

Q1: Where does this statement come from? When did it first appear?

Q2: What concrete evidence from your actual behaviour supports this statement?

Literal examples. Not “I feel bad” — but “I did X.”

Q3: What concrete evidence from your actual behaviour contradicts or complicates it?

Literal examples. This is the hardest question. Do not skip it.

Q4: If this statement were entirely true — how do you explain the evidence from Q3?

A mind holding an identity statement must ignore contradictions. Here you bring them into awareness.

Q5: What would be a more accurate identity statement — one grounded in all the evidence from both Q2 and Q3?

Example: Instead of “I am a bad parent” → “I am a parent who has lapses and who tries and who is consistently present. No parent is either perfect or simply bad.”

Step 4 — Define the new thought and anchor it (5 minutes)

Write one sentence that represents a more accurate version of the original recurring thought — grounded in the evidence you have just reviewed.

This is not an affirmation. It is not “everything is fine.” It is a thought you have earned through examination.

Example of original thought: “I am fundamentally a bad person.” New thought: “I have flaws and I have qualities. This thought comes from a period of pressure, not from an objective assessment.”

Example of original thought: “The court will rule against me.” New thought: “I do not know what the outcome will be. What I can control is preparation and conduct.”

Your new thought: ____

Anchor it: Write it on paper and put it somewhere visible, or save it in your phone as a reminder. The recurring thought will not stop immediately — but each time it arrives, you can attach the new thought to it rather than swallowing it whole.

Step 5 — Track over time

A recurring thought that has existed for years will not disappear after one pass of this protocol. But it weakens with each pass.

Log:

Date: _____
Original thought: _____
Type (prediction/assessment/identity): _____
New thought: _____
Strength before (0-10): _____
Strength after (0-10): _____
Note: _____

Once a week: look at entries for the same thought type. Is the number trending downward over time? If not — the thought is more complex and is worth exploring with a CBT-trained therapist.

Four worked examples

Example 1 — Identity statement (parenting)

Original thought: “I am not enough as a parent and my child would be better off if I were less present in their life.”

Type: Identity statement — installed through prolonged conflict.

Q1 (origin): This thought intensified during the separation. I did not have it before that.

Q2 (evidence FOR): - I sometimes raise my voice - I was physically absent some weeks due to work

Q3 (evidence AGAINST): - Every week I have a routine with my child that has functioned for years - My child comes to me when they have a problem - I have attended every important event - My child seeks my company

Q4 (explaining the contradiction): A mind holding this thought must minimise everything in Q3 as “not enough” — but that standard would not be applied to any parent anywhere.

Q5 (more accurate statement): “I am a parent who has lapses and who is consistently present and to whom my child matters. This thought is not my assessment — it was installed through a conflict situation.”

Strength before: 8/10. **After:** 4/10.

Example 2 — Prediction (outcome of proceedings)

Original thought: “I will lose the case and lose contact with my child.”

Type: Prediction.

Q1 (evidence FOR): - The other side has more resources - One decision has already gone against me

Q2 (evidence AGAINST): - I have documentation and witnesses - The previous negative decision was procedural, not on the merits - Courts generally do not exclude a parent without strong grounds

Q3 (prediction track record): Over the past year I predicted five “certain” bad outcomes. Two partially came true, three did not.

Q4 (if it comes true): I would be devastated. And — there are legal appeal pathways. I am not without options. I have survived worse than I thought I could.

Q5 (realistic prediction): “I do not know what the outcome will be. I have reason to believe I am not in an insignificant position. Preparation is what I can control.”

Strength before: 9/10. **After:** 5/10.

Example 3 — Assessment (behaviour in conflict)

Original thought: “What I said during that argument is unacceptable and proves I am not capable of normal relationships.”

Type: Assessment.

Q1 (concrete event): In one argument three months ago I said something harsh and unfair.

Q2 (the generalisation): One argument → “incapable of normal relationships” is a leap that does not follow logically.

Q3 (standard for another person): If a friend told me they had once said something harsh in an argument, I would not conclude they were “incapable of normal relationships.” I would say they were under pressure and this was an isolated event.

Q4 (fairer assessment): “I said something harsh in one argument under significant pressure. That is behaviour not to repeat — it is not a characterisation of my entire capacity for relationships.”

Strength before: 7/10. **After:** 3/10.

Example 4 — Combined (worth and future)

Original thought: “Nobody truly loves me and I will end up alone.”

Type: Identity statement + prediction. Break it into parts.

Part A — “nobody truly loves me”: Evidence FOR: Some relationships have cooled or ended during this difficult period. Evidence AGAINST: I have friends who have been there. My child wants my presence. A colleague reached out out of concern. More accurate thought: “Some relationships have cooled. I also have relationships where care is shown. ‘Nobody’ is not accurate.”

Part B — “I will end up alone”: This is a prediction based on current state, not on an inevitable future. More accurate thought: “I currently feel isolated. That is the state of this period, not a permanent outcome.”

Combined new thought: “I am going through a period of isolation that is a consequence of circumstances. That is not a permanent state nor proof of my worth.”

Strength before: 9/10. **After:** 5/10.

Integration with the rest of the path

- When a recurring thought points toward identity → [Inherited narrative audit](#)
 - When you notice the thought arriving → [Mindfulness — separation sentence](#)
 - When activation remains after the protocol → [Reset protocol](#) Tier 1
 - New thought from Step 4 → goes into [Evidence log](#) if grounded in concrete evidence
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